



SERENDIB COLLEGE

HISTORY

Ancient settlement
2026/G10&11/History/T-1

1. The history of human existence in Sri Lanka is divided into how many stages? What are they?

Stone age

proto historic era

Early historic era

2. What term refers to the period before literary sources in Sri Lanka?

pre historic era

3. What are the two cultural stages that belong to the pre-historic era of Sri Lanka?

stone age and proto historic era

4. Which term is used to describe the era involving permanent settlements, agriculture, and metal use?

proto historic era

5. What was the main dependency method of the early Homo Sapiens in Sri Lanka?

Hunting and gathering food.

6. At what depth were Stone Age tools and animal bones found in the Rathnapura gem mines?

below 90 feet

7. What is the name of the gravel layer in the semi-arid zone that contains Stone Age tools?

Irannamadu Formation

8. During which geographical era was the soil eroded from mountains to form the Rathnapura gravel layers?

Plythosin era.

Plastocene
plithosin era.

9. How many main environmental zones were inhabited by Stone Age communities in Sri Lanka? What are they?

Semi arid zone

lowland dry zone

lowland intermediate dry zone

wet zone

Mountainous dry intermediate zone

Arid zone

10. What is the primary factor used to decide the different environmental zones in Sri Lanka?

Rainfall

11. What was a major food source for Stone Age people in the lowland wet zone?

Fresh water fish in natural water pools.

12. Which animals were commonly hunted by Stone Age communities in the lowland dry zone?

gaur, buffalo, black bear, wild boar, deer, spotted deer, giant squirrel....

13. Where is the 125,000-year-old gravel layer located in the Hambanthota district?

Patna gravels near Amblanntota

14. Which Kaluthara cave was a habitation for pre-historic man?

Belilena cave at Kithulgala, Kaluthara district

15. How many years ago was the Kuruwita Batadombalena cave inhabited?

About 28,000 - 35,000 years ago

16. What is the age of the pre-historic site at Kithulgala Belilena?

About 28,000 - 35,000 years ago

17. What type of stone, known as 'Bim Weed-uru', was used for geometric stone tools?

Pure alabaster

18. Where did pre-historic humans live during the heavy rainy seasons?

In caves and Rock shelters.

19. What are examples of pre-historic outdoor camps in coastal areas?

Pannalagama, Bundala

20. Give 2 lowland dry zone cave habitations?

Barana Lena, Alu Lena

21. Which hillside locations served as outdoor hunting places for pre-historic man?

Bandenigala and Uda Walawe

22. What was the typical size of a pre-historic human group?

About 20-30 people

23. How much living area was estimated as sufficient for a family of five in the Stone Age?

15 - 20 square meters

24. How many human skeletons were discovered at the site of Bellanbendipelassa?

7 skeletons

25. How far did pre-historic people walk on average per day searching for food?

About 5-10 km per day

26. How many skeletons were discovered in the cave of Belilena in Kithulgala?

3 skeletons

27. Which food provided starch for the people of the Stone Age?

Yams, Tubers and wild bread fruit seeds

28. Which site provided evidence of baked wild breadfruit seeds from 12,500 years ago?

Fa Hirn Lena cave

29. What is the technical term for Stone Age tools under 4.5 cm in length with specific shapes?

Microoliths geometric micro stone tools

30. Which stones were primarily used to make micro stone tools?

pure alabasters, quartz and cherts.

31. What was the average height of a grown male and female Stone Age human in Sri Lanka?

male 174 cm

not more than 166 cm

female 160 cm

32. What was the average brain size of a grown male and female during the Stone Age in Sri Lanka?

male = 1600 cm³ female = 920 cm³

33. What was the estimated maximum lifespan of a pre-historic man in Sri Lanka?

About 35 - 40 years

34. Which cave near Badulla yielded a man's skull painted with red ochre?

In the cave of Ravana Ella.

35. What ritual was performed on pre-historic skeletons after they were exhumed?

Secondary burial with Red ochre

36. Remains of megalithic tradition burials signify which historical era?

Proto historic era

37. What replaced stone tool technology during the proto-historic era?

Iron tools

38. Which climatic era created an environment suitable for agriculture?

Holocene era

39. What are 'cist burials'?

Stone box burials

40. What is the term for burials where remains were deposited in clay pots?

Urn burials

41. What unique burial method was discovered at Haldummulla and Beragala?

megalithic burial

42. The characteristic of building and living in permanent settlements is known as

sedentism

43. In which district was a 3000-year-old rectangular house discovered in 2009?

Udaranchamadama in Rathnapura

44. What was found inside the house at Udaranchamadama that suggests the use of a potter's wheel?

clay wasters

45. Which iron tool found in the Udaranchamadama house indicates women's interest in beauty?

An iron stick used to apply kohl on ladies eyes

46. What does the presence of animal bones in the proto-historic house at Udaranchamadama suggest?

Domestication and meat consumption.

47. What is the main physical indicator of settlement expansion during the early historical period?

Tanks

48. What type of soil in the dry zone was preferred by early historical settlers for its fertility?

Reddish - Brown soil

49. Why did early settlements expand outside river valleys rather than inside them?

Because they get flooded often

50. What Brahmi term inscribed in Ganekanda and Gallena temples means 'anicut'?

"Vapi" or "Vapiya" Anuruna is Anuna

51. What literary term refers to villages centered around a tank?

Varigatma

52. Define 'Kasikaragama'

villages where farmers lived

53. Define 'Manikaragama'

villages where people work in gem mines live

54. Define 'Gopalagama'

villages where cowherds live

55. Define 'Kumbhakaragama'

villages where potters lived

56. Define 'Pattanagama'

villages situated close to harbours

57. Define 'Niyamgam'

trading villages

58. Define 'Olagam'

villages around tanks deserted by people

59. What term was used to introduce vast urban settlements like Anuradhapura?

Pura

60. The title 'Pura Kamatha' mentioned in a 250 B.C. inscription refers to which role?
main Architect in the city
61. Which settlement type mentioned in inscriptions was intermediate between a city and a village?
'Nagara'
62. In ancient Sri Lankan administration, who was the 'Gahapathi'?
House holder
63. What was the administrative role of the 'Gamika'?
Chief of the village
64. What was the function of the 'Dasa Gam Eththan'?
Managing administrative issues for an area consisting of 10 villages
65. Archaeologists found pits for house pillars in Anuradhapura with foundations of which two shapes?
round square
circular and rectangular
66. What was the primary means of subsistence for people living outside overflowing river valleys?
Rain-fed agriculture, irrigation tank based farming
67. Name two drought-sustainable crops grown in early historical chena cultivation.
Millet and Kurakkan
68. What is the 'Iranarnadu Deposit'?
Trunknad Deposit refers Paddy field and irrigation tank around the Irranamada tank
69. How long is a micro stone tool made of alabaster or Kahanda stones?
less than 4.5 cm
70. What is an 'overflowing valley' in geography?
It is where flood regularly occurs during rainy season
71. What is another term for the pre-historic era?
stone age

72. Which ancient chronicle mentions a well-organized society existed when Prince Vijaya arrived?

Mahawamsa and Deepawamsa

73. Define 'Parikkitta Gam'

~~Seminal~~ protected village

74. In which district is the Kolambageara Ranchamadama pre-historic cemetery located?

Sabaragamuwa district

75. The 1129 B.C. painted clay pot from Udaranchamadama was decorated with what color lines?

Red color lines

76. How many families normally lived in a small-scale ancient village?

10 - 20 families.